HELPBNK · IDEA & VALIDATION · TARGET COUNTRY: UNITED KINGDOM

Saving a deposit while paying off debt. Nobody gives them a date.

WHO · UK, 25 TO 44, RENTING, IN DEBT, WANTS TO BUY

Average unsecured debt, new debt-advice clients StepChange Statistics Yearbook 2025 · up 8% on the year	£16,874
Average home price vs median earnings, England ONS Housing Affordability 2025	7.6×
Average age of a first-time buyer ONS / Skipton · was 29 in the mid-1990s	34
First-time buyers who need two incomes to buy Skipton Home Affordability Index, March 2026	52%

TOOLS THEY USE TODAY · AND WHERE EACH ONE STOPS

Emma, Snoop	Budget today. No forward date.
Plum, Moneybox	Save and invest. Assume there's spare money.
Tembo	First-time buyers. Starts from savings, not debt.
Mouso	Debt only. No route to a home.
Bank app, spreadsheet	A balance and a lot of columns. No plan.
Vault-It	Starts below zero. One keys date, live.

WHAT THE INTERVIEWS NEED TO PROVE OR KILL

H1 · NO DATE

They can't say when they'll get the keys.

H2 · NOT READY

They wait for the debt to clear before starting a deposit.

H3 · SCATTERED

Money is split across pots, a LISA and a spreadsheet.

H4 · BANK LINKS

They won't link a bank to a new app. Manual entry feels safer.

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THE INTERVIEWS · 10 UK FIRST-TIME BUYERS · 30 MINUTES EACH

Listen first. Show Vault-It last.

WHO · FROM WHERE

Renting, saving for a first home, and paying off at least one of: credit card, loan, overdraft or buy-now-pay-later. Found through the Vault-It beta waitlist (before they log in), the HelpBnk community and my Lincoln network.

THE QUESTIONS · NO PITCH UNTIL NUMBER 6 IS DONE

1. Talk me through where you are with buying your first home.
2. What are you paying off while you save? Which one worries you most?
3. How do you keep track now: an app, bank pots, a spreadsheet, nothing? What do you hate about it?
4. When did you last try to work out when you could buy? What happened?
5. Have you ever linked your bank to a money app? Why, or why not?
6. If you could fix one thing about getting your first home, what would it be?

Then show the demo at vault-it.co/demo-a and write down the first thing they say.

RECORDING SHEET · FILLED IN AFTER EACH CALL

PROBLEM	HOW MANY	REAL EXAMPLE, IN THEIR WORDS
H1 · Can't name a buying date	__ / 10	"…"
H2 · Waiting until debt is gone	__ / 10	"…"
H3 · Money tracked in 3+ places	__ / 10	"…"
H4 · Won't link a bank to a new app	__ / 10	"…"
New problem they raised	__ / 10	"…"
First reaction to the demo	–	"…"

Pass mark: 6 of 10 can't put a date on buying. If fewer do, I change the headline, not the interviews.

Where I am: a handful of beta testers use the app each week. Their notes so far are about the app (wording, a guided tour, the starting figure, font size), not their buying struggles. These interviews fill that gap.

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